governance body offering long-term vision and the cohesiveness of strategic initiatives and far-reaching autonomy of product owners, who are capable of flexible management of their domain.

How do you do a federated data governance right? In an October 2019 Gartner report, Saul Judah lists seven foundations for good data governance (see "Best Practices for a Modern Data and Analytics Governance," http://mng.bz/Oo0R). We have divided these foundations into three main focus areas:

- Decision space
- Governance structure
- People

Let's see how federated data governance can help you lay them.

Decision space focus

The *decision space* in this context is the decision-making environment, including decision points, supporting data, possible decisions, and their quantified outcomes (e.g., within a risk management framework). If well designed, this focus ensures that decisions are consciously made and well informed. The following critical elements ensure that the decision space is built in a way that enables the decision-makers:

- *A focus on business value and organizational outcomes*—You need to ensure that your data product owners indeed work closely with their business domains. This focus will offer them a deep understanding of the immediate business needs of business units. On the other end, your central governance body should provide alignment for strategic initiatives with enterprise priorities.
- *Transparent decision-making that hews to a set of ethical principles*—The ultimate acid test for each decision is its adherence to value statements, described in section 6.3.1. Ensure that the value statement developed by the central governance body agrees with your company's